BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #5 · CHRONIC ILLNESS

"My life is over."

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Where it often comes from

A serious diagnosis or permanent change can feel like the end of the life we knew: work, plans, roles, and dreams. Grief for that life is real. But grief can slide into believing that nothing meaningful remains.

What Scripture teaches

"For I know the plans I have for you," declares the LORD (Jeremiah 29:11). Paul writes, "Therefore we do not lose heart… our light and momentary affliction is producing for us an eternal weight of glory." "In old age they will still bear fruit" (Psalm 92:14), and the psalmist asks God not to forsake him "until I proclaim Your power to the next generation." Your old life may be over, but your life is not. God is not finished with you.

> *"Therefore we do not lose heart. Though our outer self is wasting away, yet our inner self is being renewed day by day. For our light and momentary affliction is producing for us an eternal weight of glory that is far beyond comparison. So we fix our eyes not on what is seen, but on what is unseen. For what is seen is temporary, but what is unseen is eternal"* (2 Corinthians 4:16–18).

Also see

> "Even when I am old and gray, do not forsake me, O God, until I proclaim Your power to the next generation, Your might to all who are to come" (Psalm 71:18).

> "Being confident of this, that He who began a good work in you will carry it on to completion until the day of Christ Jesus" (Philippians 1:6).

> "In old age they will still bear fruit; healthy and green they will remain" (Psalm 92:14).

> "Now this is what the LORD says— He who created you, O Jacob, and He who formed you, O Israel: 'Do not fear, for I have redeemed you; I have called you by your name; you are Mine! When you pass through the waters, I will be with you; and when you go through the rivers, they will not overwhelm you. When you walk through the fire, you will not be scorched; the flames will not set you ablaze.'" (Isaiah 43:1–2).

Common self-statements

- Everything good is behind me.
- There is nothing left to live for.
- I am just waiting for the end.
- I have no purpose now.
- My dreams are dead.
- Nothing I do matters.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing life is either full or over.
- Fortune telling: Predicting nothing good will come.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling devastated and concluding that life is finished.

- Labeling: Calling myself finished.

Challenging questions

- What exactly have I lost, and what remains?
- What new things could I still do or give, even in small ways?
- Who needs what I can still offer?
- What does Scripture say about God's plans and purposes?
- What would I tell a friend in my situation?
- What is one meaningful thing I can do this week?

Truth summary

> A season of my life may have ended, but my life has not. God is not finished with me, and He can give new purpose and meaning in my new circumstances. If hopeless thoughts become heavy, I will reach out for help right away.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Hopeless
- Suffering
- Will of God
- Sickness
- Depression, Symptoms of

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Forgive/Forgiveness
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "My life is over"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"My life is over." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What exactly have I lost, and what remains?
- ☐ What new things could I still do or give, even in small ways?
- ☐ Who needs what I can still offer?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about God's plans and purposes?
- ☐ What would I tell a friend in my situation?
- ☐ What is one meaningful thing I can do this week?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I do not lose heart.
- ☐ God will finish the work He began.
- ☐ I can still bear fruit.
- ☐ God has not forsaken me.
- ☐ New purposes are possible.
- ☐ My life still matters.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **2 Corinthians 4:16–18**
  "Therefore we do not lose heart. Though our outer self is wasting away, yet our inner self is being renewed day by day. For our light and momentary affliction is producing for us an eternal weight of glory that is far beyond comparison. So we fix our eyes not on what is seen, but on what is unseen. For what is seen is temporary, but what is unseen is eternal."
- ☐ **Psalm 71:18**
  "Even when I am old and gray, do not forsake me, O God, until I proclaim Your power to the next generation, Your might to all who are to come."
- ☐ **Philippians 1:6**
  "Being confident of this, that He who began a good work in you will carry it on to completion until the day of Christ Jesus."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ New purpose: Each week, note one meaningful thing you did or gave.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, 2 Corinthians 4:16–18 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Though my outer self is wasting away, my inner self is being renewed.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Hopeless" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- ☐ Grieve honestly. Write what you have lost.
- ☐ List what remains. Write what you can still do.
- ☐ Serve in a small way. Pray, write, call, encourage.
- ☐ If you think of ending your life, call or text 988 (U.S.) now. Tell someone right away.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "My life is over": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	New purpose
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~My life is over.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, a life I knew has ended. Comfort my grief, and show me the purposes You still have for me. Do not let me lose heart. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.